

Land and Environmental art

The scope of art expanded in the late 1960s as some American and European artists began to make vast sculptures out of natural materials, often in the landscape. This became known as Land art, Environmental art or Earthworks. Seeking to move away from what they saw as the commercialism of the art world, Land art developed as part of the Conceptual art movement of the 1960s and 1970s, and had no single style or approach. Some artists sculpt into the earth, some use natural, local materials to create installations on the spot, some take natural materials back to galleries and build sculptures or installations there. Some make marks using parts of the environment, take photographs as a record and leave the land to return to its former state.

Most Land art is transitory, and most Land artists are highly respectful of the environment. Among the most prominent are Robert Smithson (1938–73), Richard Long (b.1945), Andy Goldsworthy (b.1956), Nancy Holt (b.1938), and Christo (b.1935) and Jeanne-Claude (1935–2009).



Smithson, *Spiral Jetty*, 1970